Preface

Welcome

> "*Kites rise against not with the wind.*"
>
> —John Neal, from Enterprise and Perseverance (The Weekly Mirror)

Welcome to *Spring Boot: Up and Running*. I'm glad you're here.

There are other Spring Boot books available today. Good books, written by good people. But every author makes decisions on what to include in their material, what to exclude, how to present what makes the cut, and so many more decisions large and small that make their book unique. What feels like optional material to one author may seem absolutely essential to another. We're all developers, and like all developers, we have opinions.

My opinion was that there were some missing pieces, things I felt were either necessary or just incredibly helpful to share with devs new to Spring Boot. This list of missing pieces has grown as I interact with more and more developers around the world, at various stages in their Spring Boot journey. We're all learning different things at different times in different ways. Thus this book.

If you're new to Spring Boot, or if you feel it would be useful to strengthen your knowledge of the fundamentals—and let's face it, when is it *not* useful to do that?—this book was written with you in mind. It is a gentle introduction that covers the key capabilities of Spring Boot while advancing into useful application of those capabilities *in the real world*.

Thank you for joining me on this journey. Let's begin!

Conventions Used in This Book

The following typographical conventions are used in this book:

Italic

Indicates new terms, URLs, email addresses, filenames, and file extensions.

`*Constant width*`

Used for program listings, as well as within paragraphs to refer to program elements such as variable or function names, databases, data types, environment variables, statements, and keywords.

`Constant width bold`

Shows commands or other text that should be typed literally by the user.

`*Constant width italic*`

Shows text that should be replaced with user-supplied values or by values determined by context.

TIP

This element signifies a tip or suggestion.

NOTE

This element signifies a general note.

WARNING

This element indicates a warning or caution.

Using Code Examples

Supplemental material (code examples, exercises, etc.) is available for download at *https://github.com/mkheck/springbootupandrunning*.

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Previous chapter

‹ Spring Boot: Up and Running

Next chapter

1. Spring Boot in a Nutshell ›